Graphs of Trigonometric Functions

Exam code: 9MA0

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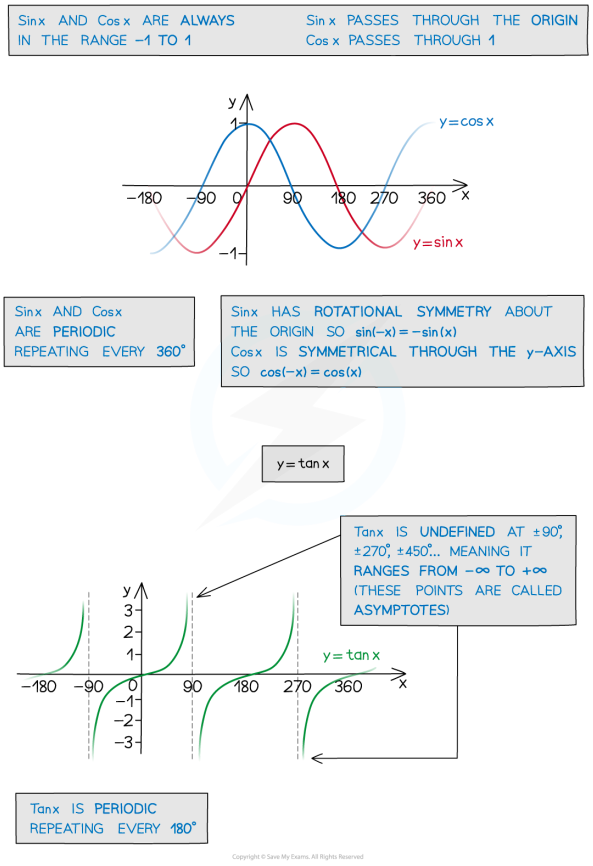
Graphs of trigonometric functions

What are the graphs of trigonometric functions?

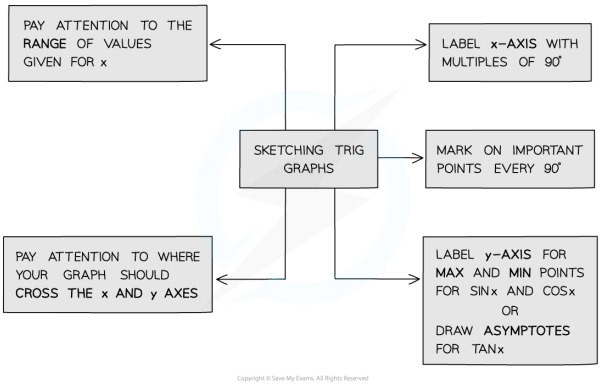
- The Trigonometric Functions Sin, Cos and Tan all have special periodic graphs that you need to be able to sketch and remember
- You'll need to know their properties and how to sketch them to solve equations and for transforming trig functions

Help me understand

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

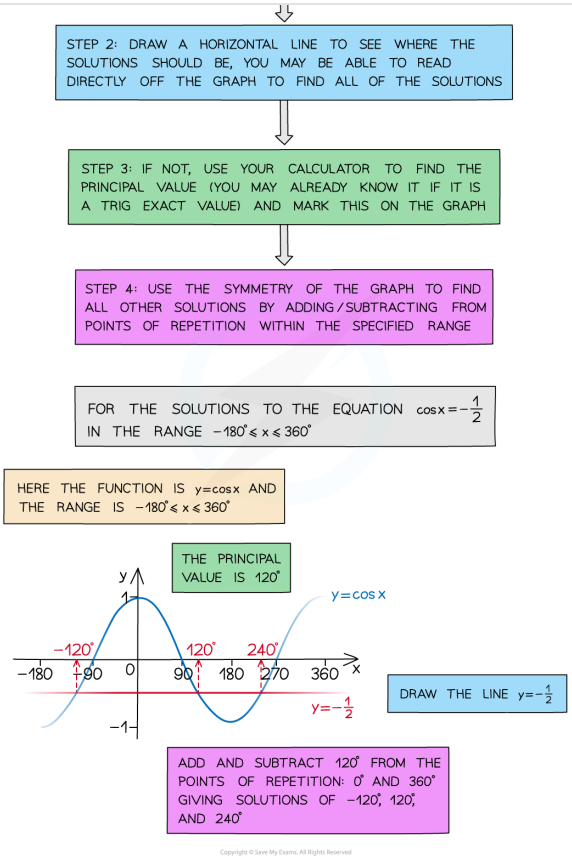


How do I sketch trigonometric graphs?



How do I use trigonometric graphs?

- By sketching the graph you can read off all the solutions in a given range (or interval)
- Your calculator will only give you the principal value
- You should recognise any values/angles associated with **exact values**
- You should be able to spot the pattern of solutions using the **symmetry** and **periodicity** of the graph



Examiner Tips and Tricks

- Always sketch with a pencil and draw a smooth curve and pay attention to the key features of each graph:
- Where it crosses the x and y axes
  - How often it repeats
  - Whether it is symmetrical
- Remember, when answering exam questions that ask for solutions, a sketch will help ensure you give **all** the appropriate solutions for a given interval.

Worked Example

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